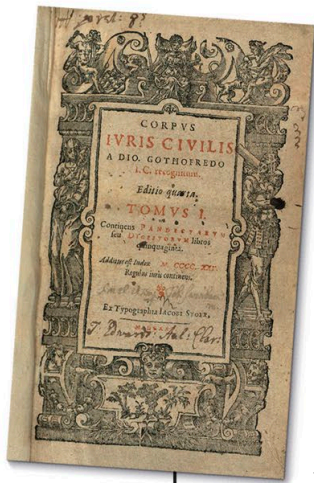




529 CE

EASTERN ROMAN EMPEROR JUSTINIAN ISSUES HIS LAW CODE

To rationalize the imperial laws that had built up over many centuries, Emperor Justinian appointed a 10-man legal commission to produce a single law code. Two years later, in 529 CE, their work was complete and the Code (together with its later revisions), became the Eastern Roman Empire's sole source of law and a hugely influential legal document for many centuries.

◀ A later edition of Justinian's *Body of Civil Law*

482–565 CE
JUSTINIAN I

One of the greatest eastern Roman emperors, Justinian reconquered lost western provinces in North Africa, Italy, and Spain, issued a new law code, and built the church of Hagia Sophia, Constantinople.

c. 535 CE **Nubia fragments** into three kingdoms – Nobatia, Alwa, and Makuria

536 CE **Eastern Roman general Belisarius** recaptures Rome from the Ostrogoths

539 CE

507 CE **Clovis defeats the Visigoths** at Vouillé, driving them into Spain



538 CE

BUDDHISM REACHES JAPAN

Keen to attract allies against China, the ruler of the Korean state of Baekje sent a mission to Japan, which carried with it images of the Buddha and sacred texts. The religion faced fierce opposition from Japanese nobles, but the emperor Kinmei entrusted the Buddhist gifts to Soga no Iname, whose clan became the first Japanese Buddhists and built its first Buddhist temple, the Asuka-Dera.

△ Asuka-dera temple, Japan

Average summer temperatures fell by 2 °C (3.6 °F) in summer 536 CE, beginning the coldest decade in Europe for over 2,000 years